

India and China

India and China were home to two of world's earliest and most influential civilizations. Both civilizations develop complex societies, political structures and cultural traditions that shaped their histories and continue to impact the world today. Here's an overview of early Indian and Chinese civilizations:

Early Indian Civilization (Indus valley civilization)

Time period: Around 3300-1300 BCE
(peak: 2600-1900 BCE)

Major cities: Harappa and Mohenjo-Daro.

Geography: Located in the Indus River Valley (Modern-day Pakistan and northwest India).

Achievement:

Advanced urban planning with

grid pattern streets
Sophisticated drainage and sewage systems.

Use of standardized weights and measures

Trade with Mesopotamia

Writing system:
(Still undeciphered)

Decline: Causes are unclear but may include climate change, natural disasters or Aryan migration around 1500 BCE.

. Later Indian Civilization (Vedic period & Maurya Empire)

Vedic period: (1500 - 500 BCE):

Aryan introduced Sanskrit, Hinduism and the caste system.

Maurya Empire (321 - 185 BCE):

Chandragupta Maurya established the first large empire in India, and Ashoka spread Buddhism.

Chinese Civilization.

Early Chinese Civilization (Shang and Zhou Dynasties)

Shang Dynasty (c. 1600-1046 BCE)

- First Chinese dynasty with written records (oracle bones)
- Bronze metallurgy, walled cities and a ruling king with noble support.
- Ancestor worship and early Chinese writing system.

Zhou Dynasty (1046 - 256 BCE)

- * Introduced the Mandate of Heaven (divine right to rule)
- * Feudal system with local lords ruling smaller regions.
- * Confucianism and Daoism emerged during this period.
- * Iron tools and agricultural advances improved farming.

Later Chinese Civilization (Qin & Han Dynasty)

Qin Dynasty: (221-206 BCE):

Unified China, built the first Great Wall and standardized weights, measures and script.

Han Dynasty: (206 BCE-220 CE)

Expanded trade (Silk Road), developed Confucian bureaucracy, and made advances in science and technology.

* — Both civilizations laid the foundation of their modern nations and had lasting impacts on religion, governance and culture.

Ancient World:

Greece & Rome and the Hellenic world.